

W H A L E C L A S S

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day

My 5 Senses

Week 5

Week of Sep 14–18

13 minutes a day

ages 2.5–6

English learners





Week 5 · Week Overview

My 5 Senses

Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week

5 words they'll own by Friday →

see

hear

touch

smell

taste

Little's (2.5–3)

One word + a gesture is a win: **"See!"**

(two fingers to the eyes, then point),

"Hear!" (cup both ears, lean in),

"Touch!" (wiggle all ten fingers).

Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **"I see a red apple."**

"I hear a bell."

"I touch something soft."

"I can ____!"

The week at a glance

MON	Two Little Eyes	a magnifying glass and one tiny thing to look at in the Magic Box
TUE	Listen! Sh...	a little bell and a pair of sound cylinders in the Magic Box; a cloth big enough to hide thing...
WED	Feel It · Sink or Float	a feely bag in the Magic Box
THU	Sniff, Sniff, Sniff	three smelling jars in the Magic Box
FRI	Taste It! + Big Review	a tasting tray

2 MIN

Magic Box hook



4 MIN

Teach the words



3 MIN

Song · today's verse



3 MIN

Game · move it



1 MIN

Whisper-shout close

Weekly rituals — use these every single day

Attention grabber: Teacher: **"One, two, three — eyes on me!"** · Kids: **"One, two — eyes on you!"**

The Magic Box: any box with a lid. Chant it, shake it, sniff it, peek dramatically — the day's key prop lives inside.

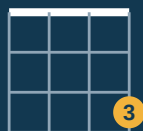
The two-tier rule: never make a little produce a sentence, and never let a big get away with one word.

Whisper → shout close: calms them down, then releases them — every single closing.

Teacher-fails-on-purpose: once a day, get it wrong and let them correct you — the correction shout is the loudest language of the day.

One song a week: same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Friday.

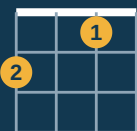
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G C E A

C

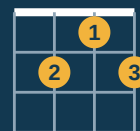
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G C E A

F

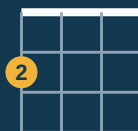
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G C E A

G7

0 0 0



G C E A

Am

Uke quick-ref

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up ("sing — song — sing-a"). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

The song needs only **C · F · G7 · Am**.

MONDAY

Two Little Eyes

Today's words: **see**

Grab: a **magnifying glass** and one tiny thing to look at in the Magic Box — a seed, a beetle wing, a grain of rice; one red thing and one round thing hidden in plain sight round the room; the sight character card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today we **look** at the box. Turn it slowly so everyone sees every side. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it — the tiniest tick. Peek in, and go completely still: (*whisper*) "It's so... **small**. I can hardly **SEE** it."

TEACHER "I need my eyes. I need **two** eyes... and this!" (*lift the magnifying glass out slowly, hold it over one eye — your eye goes enormous*)

They shriek. Two fingers to the eyes, then point. "**See!**"

4 MIN TEACH · SEE

Hold up the seed on your flat palm. Everyone leans in.

Two little **eyes**... (*two fingers pointing at your own eyes*)

Open them **WIDE**. (*eyes huge, eyebrows up*)

I can **see!** (*point out at the room*)

I see... a seed! (*hold it up*)

Now the magnifying glass goes round the circle, one child at a time, ten seconds each: look at the seed, then say what you see.

LITTLES say the one word "**See!**" or just the thing — "**Seed!**" **BIGS** take the full frame: "**I see a little seed.**"

Then eyes shut, tight, everybody. Move one thing in the circle. Eyes open — **what changed?** Do it three times. They will out-see you every time.

Teacher fails: hold the magnifying glass against your **ear** and announce "Oh! Now I can SEE the seed!" Nod, pleased. Wait. Let them move your hand to your eye themselves.

Lay the **sight** card beside the magnifying glass on the mat. Say it once, in Chinese, and leave it there — one character a day, no drilling.

3 MIN GAME · I SPY WITH MY LITTLE EYE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Everyone sits tall and gets their "binoculars" up (two curled fists at the eyes).

TEACHER "I spy with my little eye... something **RED!**" (*scan the room slowly through your fists*)

Hands up, then the child points and names it. "**Red!**" **BIGS** "**I see a red book.**"

Six rounds — something red, something round, something blue, something **tiny**, something with a face on it, something that is YOU. Then two children get to be the spy while the class hunts.

Colours and shapes only, never letters — "something beginning with..." loses every English learner in the room. Point-and-name is the whole game.

1 MIN CLOSE

Hands over the eyes, then fling them open on the shout. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "See... see... SEE!" (*hands fly off the eyes on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Brown Bear, Brown Bear, What Do You See?* (Bill Martin Jr & Eric Carle) — they will chant "What do you see?" with you by page three.

› **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · TWO LITTLE EYES** chorus → Monday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Two little eyes that **F** look and **C** SEE, (*point to both eyes*)

F Two little ears that **C** listen to **G7** me! **C** (*cup both ears*)

C Ten little fingers that **F** touch and **C** know, (*wiggle all ten*)

Am One nose, one **F** tongue — **G7** off we **C** go! (*tap your nose, poke your tongue out*)

MONDAY · SEE

C I see the sun, I see the tree, (*point up, then across*)

G7 Open my eyes — **C** what do I see? (*hands over eyes, then fling them open*)

The one song of the week — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab. The chorus is a finger-play: they will do the actions before they can sing the words.

TUESDAY

Listen! Sh...

Today's words: **hear** (*see comes back every day*)

Grab: a little bell and a pair of **sound cylinders** in the Magic Box; a cloth big enough to hide things behind; a bunch of keys, a sheet of paper, a jug and a cup of water; the hearing card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today **nobody looks**. Box chant with your eyes shut — make them shut theirs too.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it. *Ting... ting... ting.* Shake it again, softer. Hold it to one ear, then the other.

TEACHER "I can't see it. But I can **HEAR** it! What is it?" (*shake once more, then lift out the bell and ring it high*)

Cup both ears, lean in. "**Hear!**"

4 MIN TEACH • HEAR

Ring the bell right up loud, then so quietly that the back of the circle has to lean forward.

Loud! (*ring hard, hands off ears*)

Soft... (*the tiniest ring, everyone leans in*)

Sh... (*finger on lips*)

I can **hear!** (*cup both ears*)

Now the silence game: everybody still, eyes shut, ten whole seconds. Then hands up — what did you hear? A car. A bird. A door. Somebody's tummy. Take every answer; the Littles will just say "**Hear!**" and point at their ear, and that counts. **BIGS** "**I hear a bird.**"

Finish with the sound cylinders: shake one, shake its partner, shake a stranger. Same or different? Two children come and find the pair.

Teacher fails: hold the bell to your **nose** and sniff it, hard, twice. "Mmm! I can hear it beautifully." Wait for them to march your hand up to your ear.

The **hearing** card goes down beside the bell, next to yesterday's sight.

3 MIN GAME • GUESS THAT SOUND

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Then: "Eyes... CLOSED." You work behind the cloth.

TEACHER "Listen... what is it?" (*crumple the paper slowly*)

"**Paper!**" **BIGS** "**I hear paper.**"

Six sounds: the bell, the keys, crumpling paper, water pouring from the jug into the cup, two hands clapping, and your own shoes walking. Then one child hides behind the cloth and chooses; the class guesses.

Do the water one last and pour it high — it is the sound they all get right and the one they ask for again tomorrow.

1 MIN CLOSE

Hands cupped at the ears, leaning in. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Hear... hear... **HEAR!**" (*one bright ring of the bell on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Peace at Last* (Jill Murphy) — every page is a noise. Make the noise with them; don't read the sentences.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT • TWO LITTLE EYES chorus → Tuesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Two little eyes that **F** look and **C** SEE, (*point to both eyes*)

F Two little ears that **C** listen to **G7** me! **C** (*cup both ears*)

C Ten little fingers that **F** touch and **C** know, (*wiggle all ten*)

Am One nose, one **F** tongue — **G7** off we **C** go! (*tap your nose, poke your tongue out*)

TUESDAY • HEAR

C Shhh! I hear a little sound, (*finger on lips, then cup one ear*)

G7 Ears wide open — **C** listen all round! (*cup both ears and turn right round*)

Sing this verse *quietly*, then have them sing it in a whisper. A whispered song makes twenty children listen to each other — which is the lesson.

WEDNESDAY

Feel It · Sink or Float

Today's words: **touch** (see · hear come back)

Grab: a **feely bag** in the Magic Box — a pinecone, a silk scarf, a square of sandpaper; a **basin of water**, a stone and a cork, two labelled dishes (sink · float) and a towel; the touch card; the open window for the poem.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today we **reach in without looking**. The box comes out with a cloth bag sitting inside it.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Hand in, eyes up at the ceiling, feeling about. Narrate it: "Ooh... it's **bumpy**... it's **pointy**... it's... a PINECONE!" Out it comes.

TEACHER "I never looked once. My **fingers** knew." (hold up all ten and wiggle them)

Everyone wiggles ten fingers. "**Touch!**"

4 MIN TEACH · TOUCH

Three things go round the circle, one at a time, everyone gets a feel:

Pinecone — **bumpy!** (fingers tapping in the air)

Silk — **soft...** (stroke your own cheek with it)

Sandpaper — **rough!** (scrub your fingertips across it)

LITTLES say the feeling word and wiggle their fingers: "**Soft!**" **BIGS** take the frame: "**I touch something soft.**"

Then the bag again, this time for them: reach in, **name it before you pull it out**. Right or wrong, everybody claps — the bag is its own control of error, you pull it out and you see.

Teacher fails: pull out the **sandpaper**, stroke it lovingly down your cheek and sigh "Ahhh... so **SOFT**." Offer it to a child to stroke. Wait.

Chinese moment (2 min, at the open window): read "Early Autumn" Meng Haoran — "Before you notice it the early-autumn nights grow long, and the fresh wind turns cool again." Then everyone goes silent and uses all five senses on early autumn: what can you **hear**? what can you **feel** on your face? what does the air **smell** like now? Lay the **touch** card with the others.

3 MIN GAME · SINK OR FLOAT?

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The basin comes to the middle of the circle, the two dishes either side: **sink** and **float**.

TEACHER "**Hold** it first. Heavy? Or light? Now **guess** — sink, or float?"

Each child holds the object, feels the weight, guesses, and then drops it in and watches. "**Sink!**" "**Float!**" **BIGS** "**The stone sinks. The cork floats.**"

Eight objects: stone, coin, key, metal spoon, marble — cork, leaf, feather, apple, wooden block. Wrong guesses are the best bit; nobody is wrong, the **water** answers.

Guess **before** the drop, every single time. The touch comes first (heavy / light), then the prediction, then the water tells the truth — that is the whole experiment, and it lives on the shelf all week.

1 MIN CLOSE

Ten fingers wiggling in the air. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Touch... touch... **TOUCH!**" (all ten fingers wiggling high on the shout)

Got 3 spare minutes? Any *That's Not My...* touchy-feely book (Fiona Watt) — pass it round, every child gets one patch to stroke and one word: soft, rough, bumpy.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · TWO LITTLE EYES** chorus → Wednesday's verse → chorus**CHORUS**

C Two little eyes that **F** look and **C** **SEE**, (point to both eyes)

F Two little ears that **C** listen to **G7** me! **C** (cup both ears)

C Ten little fingers that **F** touch and **C** know, (wiggle all ten)

Am One nose, one **F** tongue — **G7** off we **C** go! (tap your nose, poke your tongue out)

WEDNESDAY · TOUCH

C Soft and bumpy, wet and dry, (stroke, tap, splash, brush palms)

G7 My fingers know — **C** let me try! (both hands out, palms up)

Sing it once with hands behind backs and once with hands out in front. They notice the difference themselves.

THURSDAY

Sniff, Sniff, Sniff

Today's words: **smell** (see · hear · touch come back)

Grab: three **smelling jars** in the Magic Box — orange peel, a mint leaf, fresh ginger (cotton wool in a small jar, lid on); the three real things laid out on a mat across the room; the smell card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today we **sniff** the box. Lift the lid a crack and sniff at the gap, eyes closed, for a long moment.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

TEACHER "Mmmm... I can't see it. I can't hear it. But my **nose** knows!" (*tap your nose twice*)

Carry the open box round the circle so every child gets one sniff before anything comes out. Then lift out the orange jar.

Tap your nose. **"Smell!"**

4 MIN TEACH · SMELL

One jar at a time, lid off, round the circle. Big sniff, then the face that goes with it.

Orange! (*sniff, eyes wide, big smile*)

Mint! (*sniff, whole face freshens up*)

Ginger! (*sniff, nose wrinkles, head back*)

LITTLES sniff and say the one word — **"Orange!"** — or just pull the face, which is also an answer. **BIGS** **"I smell an orange."** and **"I like it."** / **"I don't like it!"**

Then all three jars with eyes shut: can you tell them apart with your nose alone? Two children at a time.

Teacher fails: hold the jar up to your **eye** like the magnifying glass and peer into it: "Nothing there! I can't smell a single thing." Wait for twenty children to shout your own nose at you.

The **smell** card joins the row. Four down, one to go — point along the line and let them tell you which one is missing.

3 MIN GAME · SNIFF AND FIND

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The three real objects — orange peel, mint, ginger — are waiting on a mat across the room.

TEACHER "Sniff the jar... now GO and find it!" (*hold a jar under a child's nose*)

They run, choose, hold it up. The class calls it: **"Orange!"** **BIGS** bring it back and say **"I smell an orange."**

Every child gets a turn — it takes about eight seconds each. Last two rounds, send two children at once and let them race.

If a child hesitates at the mat, let a friend go and stand beside them. Nobody sits down without having held something.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody's finger on their nose. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Smell... smell... SMELL!" (*one enormous sniff all together on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Little Mouse, the Red Ripe Strawberry, and the Big Hungry Bear* (Don & Audrey Wood) — the whole book is about a smell nobody can resist.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · TWO LITTLE EYES chorus → Thursday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Two little eyes that **F** look and **C** SEE, (*point to both eyes*)

F Two little ears that **C** listen to **G7** me! **C** (*cup both ears*)

C Ten little fingers that **F** touch and **C** know, (*wiggle all ten*)

Am One nose, one **F** tongue — **G7** off we **C** go! (*tap your nose, poke your tongue out*)

THURSDAY · SMELL

C Sniff, sniff, sniff — what's in the jar? (*three loud sniffs, hold up a jar*)

G7 My good nose knows **C** near and far! (*tap your nose, then point far away*)

Three real sniffs on "sniff, sniff, sniff" — loud ones. It is the funniest line of the week and they will do it in the corridor.

FRIDAY

Taste It! + Big Review

Today's words: **see · hear · touch · smell · taste** — the whole week

Grab: a **tasting tray** — lemon slices, honey, a plain cracker, one clean teaspoon per child; every prop from the week back in the box (magnifying glass, bell, feely bag, jars); the awards (print pack page 17); the taste card.
Check allergies first.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out fat, rattling, and smelling of lemon.

TEACHER "Today the box is **FULL!** Which sense do we need?"

Pull the props out one at a time and hold each up in silence — they will supply the word before you can.

Magnifying glass → **"See!"** Bell → **"Hear!"** Feely bag → **"Touch!"** Jar → **"Smell!"**

Last of all, the lemon. Everyone waits. **"TASTE!"**

4 MIN TEACH • TASTE, THEN THE WHOLE WEEK

One clean spoon per child, three tastes, faces allowed to be enormous:

Honey — sweet! (*eyes closed, big slow smile*)

Lemon — sour! (*whole face screws up, everyone screams*)

Cracker — plain. (*shrug, chew, nod*)

LITTLES say the one word and pull the face: **"Sour!"** **BIGS** **"I taste a lemon. It is sour!"**

Then everybody stands and we tell the whole week with our bodies, twice — slow, then fast:

Two eyes — I **see!** (*point at eyes, then out*)

Two ears — I **hear!** (*cup both ears*)

Ten fingers — I **touch!** (*wiggle all ten*)

One nose — I **smell!** (*tap your nose*)

One tongue — I **TASTE!** (*tongue out, everybody*)

Teacher fails: put the lemon slice to your **ear** and listen hard. "Hmm. It doesn't taste of anything." Hold the pose. Let them fix you twice.

Allergy check before you start, and one spoon per child — never a shared spoon. A child who won't taste can smell instead and still shout the word.

3 MIN GAME • WHICH SENSE?

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Props in a heap in the middle. Hold one up; the class shouts which sense it needs and does the gesture.

TEACHER "Which sense? ... and what do we DO?"

Magnifying glass → **"See!"** (*fingers to eyes*)

Bell → **"Hear!"** (*cup ears*)

Sandpaper → **"Touch!"** (*wiggle ten fingers*)

Jar → **"Smell!"** (*tap nose*)

Lemon → **"Taste!"** (*tongue out*)

Go round twice, faster the second time, then let a Big hold the props. **BIGS** owe you a sentence — **"I hear a bell."** — **LITTLES** owe you a word and a gesture.

Slip one thing in that needs **two** senses — the orange. Watch them argue. Both answers are right; say so out loud.

1 MIN CLOSE + AWARDS

Every child gets a "You are a STAR!" award to take home with the sink-or-float news. Then, standing, with all five gestures:

EVERYONE "See... hear... touch... smell... TASTE!" (*eyes · ears · fingers · nose · tongue out on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Lemons Are Not Red* (Laura Vaccaro Seeger) — every page is a "no it isn't!" Perfect for a class that has spent all week correcting you.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT • TWO LITTLE EYES Friday's verse, then the WHOLE song, top to bottom

CHORUS

C Two little eyes that **F** look and **C** SEE, (*point to both eyes*)

F Two little ears that **C** listen to **G7** me! **C** (*cup both ears*)

C Ten little fingers that **F** touch and **C** know, (*wiggle all ten*)

Am One nose, one **F** tongue — **G7** off we **C** go! (*tap your nose, poke your tongue out*)

FRIDAY • TASTE

C Sweet and sour upon my tongue, (*big smile, then a screwed-up face*)

G7 Taste it, taste it — **C** yum, yum, yum! (*rub your tummy three times*)

The finale: chorus → Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday → chorus, top to bottom. They learned it one verse a morning without noticing, and this run-through is the review of the whole week.

★ Two Little Eyes

Week 5 theme song
C (0003) · F (2010) · G7 (0212) · Am (2000)

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, full song on Friday.

CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

- C** Two little eyes that **F** look and **C** SEE, *(point to both eyes)*
F Two little ears that **C** listen to **G7** me! **C** *(cup both ears)*
C Ten little fingers that **F** touch and **C** know, *(wiggle all ten)*
Am One nose, one **F** tongue — **G7** off we **C** go! *(tap your nose, poke your tongue out)*

MONDAY · SEE

- C** I see the sun, I see the tree, *(point up, then across)*
G7 Open my eyes — **C** what do I see? *(hands over eyes, then fling them open)*

TUESDAY · HEAR

- C** Shhh! I hear a little sound, *(finger on lips, then cup one ear)*
G7 Ears wide open — **C** listen all round! *(cup both ears and turn right round)*

WEDNESDAY · TOUCH

- C** Soft and bumpy, wet and dry, *(stroke, tap, splash, brush palms)*
G7 My fingers know — **C** let me try! *(both hands out, palms up)*

THURSDAY · SMELL

- C** Sniff, sniff, sniff — what's in the jar? *(three loud sniffs, hold up a jar)*
G7 My good nose knows **C** near and far! *(tap your nose, then point far away)*

FRIDAY · TASTE

- C** Sweet and sour upon my tongue, *(big smile, then a screwed-up face)*
G7 Taste it, taste it — **C** yum, yum, yum! *(rub your tummy three times)*

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“sing — song — sing-a”).

Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: **C** (4 strums) → **F** (4 strums) → **C** → **G7** → **C**. Add **Am** last: it is one finger on the same string as F, so slide from Am to F and back until it stops feeling like a change. That's the entire song — and the five verses are only C and G7. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down and do the finger-play instead: the class will not notice, and the actions carry the meaning either way.